

Prediction markets ask where the price *ends*.
Wick asks whether the price *wicks* into a level —
and lets you ride that question tick by tick.

Network	Sui testnet demo only — not for mainnet
Surface	Touch · No-Touch · Double-No-Touch · Ride
Settlement	Oracle-observed barrier crosses
Collateral	One Martingaler vault per asset
Status	Full bet → settle → payout cycle live

The problem

You can bet on where BTC *ends up* in a day, a week, a month — that's the prediction-market product. You can also buy or sell a vanilla call / put — that's the options product. But neither of them is what most people watching a chart actually want.

When a trader stares at a candle, the question on their mind is rarely *"where will it close?"* It's *"will it spike up to this level before it pulls back?"* That question is path-dependent — it depends on whether the price *touched* a barrier at any moment during a window, not where it ended up. The classic financial product that answers this is the **touch / no-touch barrier option**: a binary payoff that pays if the price ever crossed a level before expiry, and pays nothing if it didn't.

Touch options have existed on professional desks for decades. They have almost never been available on-chain in a usable form, for two reasons:

- **The accounting is hard.** Touch options have asymmetric payoffs that depend on the entire price path, not just an endpoint. Naive implementations either lose money to MEV at the boundary or hand out payouts that the vault cannot cover.
- **Short-dated UX is unforgiving.** Picking an expiry, a barrier, and a side three times a minute is exhausting. The product needs to feel like a screen-gesture, not a multi-step trade ticket.

Wick exists to ship touch options as a casual on-screen product: a screen where you tap the candle, watch your PnL move with the price, and release to cash out — or hold and let the keeper settle you for the touch jackpot.

What Wick is

Wick is a protocol for **short-dated barrier options on oracle-observed prices**, with a small surface of related exotics and one streaming primitive that turns the touch option into a held gesture.

The trading surface has four products:

Product	The bet you are making	You win if...
TOUCH single barrier	The price will wick past a chosen level before the timer runs out.	The oracle records a barrier cross before expiry. Pays a fixed multiple of your stake.
NO-TOUCH single barrier	The price will <i>not</i> reach the level before the timer runs out.	The oracle never records a barrier cross before expiry. Pays a fixed multiple of your stake.

Product	The bet you are making	You win if...
DNT INSIDE DNT OUTSIDE	Double-no-touch: the price will stay inside a corridor (<i>inside</i>) or break out of it (<i>outside</i>).	<i>Inside</i> : neither the upper nor lower barrier is touched. <i>Outside</i> : either one is.
RIDE streaming touch	You hold the position open while watching the chart. The longer you hold, the bigger your stake — and the bigger your payout if you get touched.	The barrier is touched while you are still holding. You can also <i>cash out</i> at any moment for a partial refund.

All four products settle against a price **oracle**, not against a separate trade book. That is the central honest claim of the protocol: *Wick pays out when the oracle says the barrier was crossed, not when an exchange tick somewhere else printed a wick*. The oracle can be Pyth, Lazer, a Switchboard pull adapter, or — for the arcade underlyings — a transparent on-chain random walk. Settlement is permissionless: anyone can poke the contract to advance state.

What you see and do on the platform

1 Pick a market.

A row of cards shows the active markets — asset, barrier level, time left, payout multiple, current odds-implied price. You don't have to build a position; the parameters are already set. Pick the card that matches your view.

2 Pick a side and a stake.

Two buttons: *touch* or *no-touch* (or, for the corridor product, *inside* or *outside*). Type a stake. You see the maximum payout, the maximum loss, and a payoff bar before you confirm. There is no margin, no leverage, no liquidation. Your max loss is your stake.

3 Watch the candle.

The position sits on your screen. The candle ticks against the barrier. You can keep adding positions, or just watch.

4 Or — for a Ride — tap and hold.

On a Ride market, you tap the chart and the position opens. Stake accumulates while your finger is down. PnL moves in real time as the price moves. Release the chart and you cash out at the current value. Hold past a barrier touch and you win the touch jackpot at the market's payout multiple.

5 Settle and redeem.

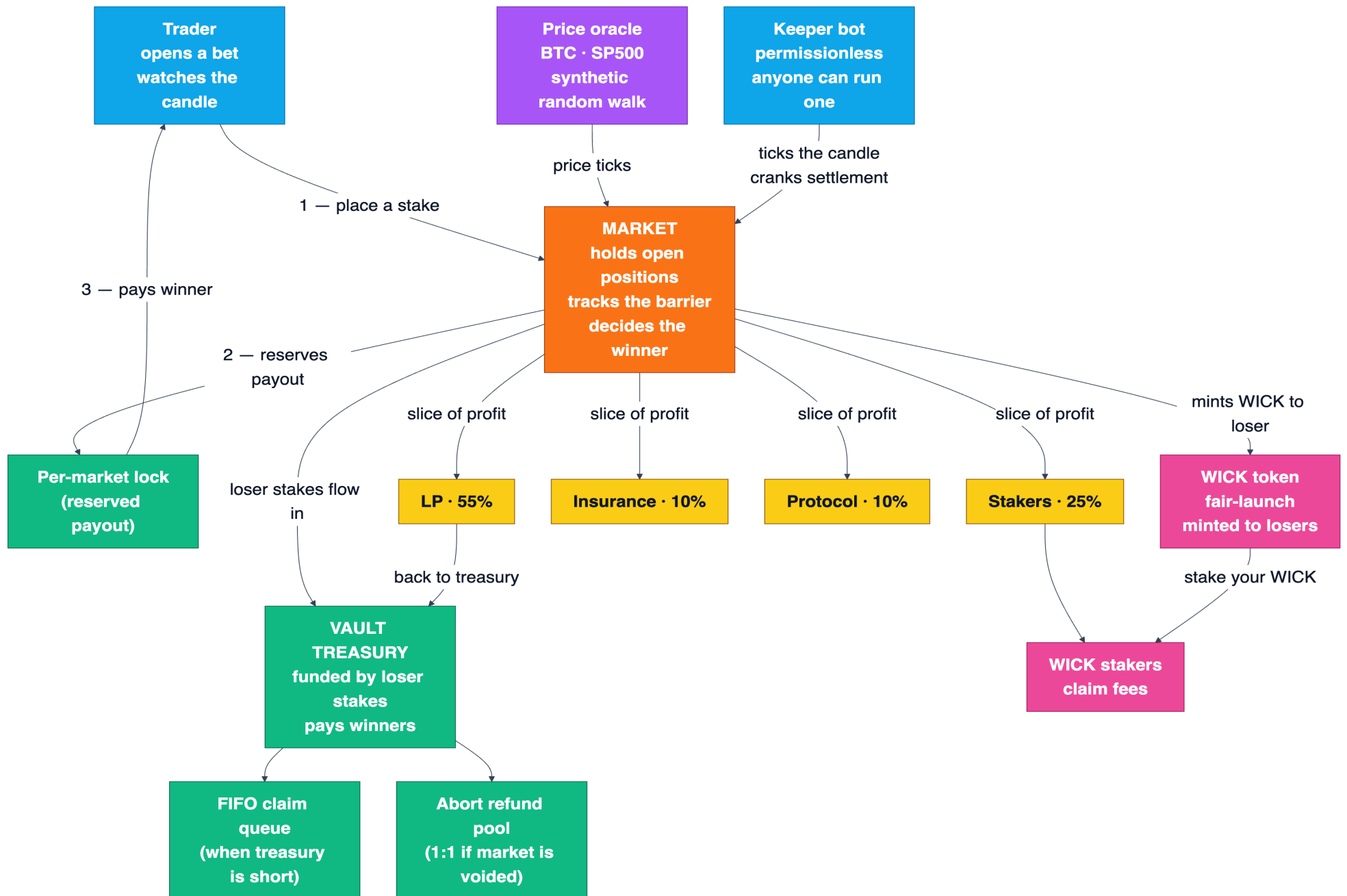
When the timer runs out (or the barrier is touched, depending on the product), the market settles. The winning side redeems their stake and receives the payout. The losing side receives

WICK tokens

in proportion to their loss — Wick's fair-launch token whose holders receive a share of every market's fees going forward.

How it works — the mechanism

Underneath the surface, Wick is built around three connected systems: a **market** that turns a price path into a binary outcome, a **vault** that recycles losing stakes into liquidity, and a **fair-launch token** that points future fee flow at the people who lost money funding the vault in the first place. The diagram on the next page shows how money moves between them; the sections that follow walk through each piece in plain English.



How money moves through the protocol. The trader places a stake into a market; the market reserves a payout from the vault and reads the oracle to decide who won; on settlement, losers fund the vault and receive WICK, winners are paid from the vault, and a slice of profit is split into four fee buckets.

The accounting model — the Martingaler vault

Every market that uses a given collateral (e.g. SUI) is backed by a single shared vault for that collateral. The vault is the protocol's only liquidity provider. **It is bootstrapped from \$0 by cumulative trader losses** — there is no LP token to mint, no incentive program to subsidize early liquidity, no team allocation seeded into it. The vault grows when traders lose and shrinks when traders win.

This is the *Martingaler* accounting model: an LP-from-losses pool designed for products where the long-run house edge is well-defined. Because Wick's payouts are bounded (you cannot lose more than your stake, you cannot win more than the market's quoted multiple), the vault always has a finite obligation per market, and the cumulative drift is predictable.

The four pockets inside the vault

Pocket	Purpose
Treasury	The free, available liquidity. Loser stakes flow in. Winner payouts flow out. Most of the vault sits here.
Per-market settlement lock	When a market settles, the obligation to its winning side is moved out of the treasury and into a lock dedicated to that market. The lock cannot be drained by any other market. Winners on that market always have a place to draw from, even if a different market settles unfavorably one block later.
Side bucket	When stake flows in while the treasury already owes money to a queued winner from a past settlement, the new inflow is held in a side bucket and auto-routed to the queue head on the same transaction. This guarantees the queue always makes forward progress.
Abort refund pool	If a market is voided (oracle staleness, not enough observations to settle honestly), <i>both sides</i> get a 1:1 refund of their stake. The abort pool is a dedicated reserve so a voided market cannot freeze healthy ones.

The FIFO claim queue — the safety valve

In any LP-backed product there is a worst-case scenario where the vault's obligation to winners temporarily exceeds the treasury. Wick handles this with a **first-in / first-out claim queue**: if a winner redeems and the treasury cannot fully cover the payout, the shortfall is enqueued as a claim. The next inflows of loser stakes pay queued claims before they top up the treasury. The queue is monotonic — claims are never reordered, never dropped, never re-priced.

Why this is safe: the vault's total obligation across all open markets is capped by the protocol's global exposure policy. A market cannot open positions whose payout, weighted by current odds, would push aggregate exposure past the cap. The queue exists as a *smoothing mechanism for honest cash flow timing*, not as a way to defer bankruptcy.

The collateral invariant

After every action — every open, every settlement, every redemption, every refund, every fee accrual — the protocol re-checks one identity:

what the vault holds = what every open position can claim

This is the load-bearing safety property. If it is ever violated, by even one unit, the protocol halts. It is asserted in over two hundred tests covering every primitive on its own and every combination of primitives that can occur in a real lifecycle.

The fee model — asymmetric impact

Wick charges a fee on **profit**, not on stake. Losers pay nothing beyond their stake; winners pay a small percentage of the profit portion of their redemption. This keeps the price of entering a position visible up front and refunds the fee entirely on a market that voids.

The novel part is that the fee is *asymmetric*: it scales with how **decisive** the win was, and how **vulnerable** the vault was when the position opened.

Decisiveness

A touch that just grazes the barrier is worth less to the protocol — it was a close call, and the vault could easily have been on the other side. A touch that overshoots the barrier by a wide margin is a decisive win. Decisive wins pay a higher fee rate. The effect is that traders who hug the barrier (the riskiest, most MEV-prone positions) pay less, and traders who take genuinely directional positions on a wide range pay more.

Vulnerability

When a winner redeems against a thinly-funded vault, their payout represents a larger fraction of the vault's free liquidity. That payout is more impactful to the LP than the same payout drawn against a deep treasury. The fee scales with the payout's vulnerability factor — large draws against thin treasuries pay more than small draws against deep ones.

The corridor (DNT) product uses two separate decisiveness shapes — one for an *inside* winner (priced against the smallest distance to either barrier) and one for an *outside* winner (priced against how far past the corridor the price actually went). The asymmetric model preserves its incentive properties on both sides.

Where the fee goes

The accrued fee is split into four buckets on every settlement:

Bucket	Share	Recipient
LP	55%	Returned to the vault treasury. The LP that backed every market grows from this.
Stakers	25%	Claimable by WICK stakers (see below).
Insurance	10%	Held in reserve against the worst-case bankruptcy clause; not callable in normal operation.
Protocol	10%	Routed to the protocol treasury.

The WICK token — losers get the launch

Most token launches reward people who never used the product. WICK reverses that. **The only way to receive WICK in the launch window is to lose money trading on the protocol.**

Mint to losers

When a market settles and a position is on the losing side, the trader receives WICK proportional to the dollar value of their loss. No presale, no team allocation, no airdrop, no incentive program — and no way for a non-trader to acquire WICK in the launch phase other than by buying it from a trader who earned it.

Stake for fees

Holding WICK is not enough. To receive a share of the stakers' fee bucket, you stake your WICK into the staking pool. Stakers claim their pro-rata share of fees accrued since they staked. Unstaking has a delay so a staker cannot front-run a settlement.

Anti-loop protections

A trader could in principle try to loop — lose money to mint WICK, stake it, recover the loss via fees. WICK's design prevents this: mint sizes are capped per address and per market, the dividend snapshot is taken at the moment of staking (so you cannot claim back fees that accrued before your stake), and forfeited stake that exceeds the cap is auto-routed to the insurance bucket.

The Ride primitive

Ride is Wick's signature streaming product. It turns the touch option from a one-shot bet into a held gesture.

When you open a Ride, you escrow a budget. Your stake then accumulates continuously while the position is open. The longer you hold, the bigger the bet — and the bigger the touch jackpot would be if you got touched right now. PnL moves in real time. You release to cash out. You hold to ride.

A Ride has four ways to end:

Outcome	When it happens	What you receive
Touch win	The barrier is touched while you are still holding.	Your accumulated stake times the market's payout multiple, plus the unused portion of your escrow. Ties at the close boundary go to the trader.
Cash out	You release before the barrier is touched and before the timer ends.	A fraction of your accumulated stake based on how close the price is to the barrier and how much time is left, minus a small spread. Always less than or equal to what you put in — the cashout is genuinely an exit, not a guaranteed profit.
Expired loss	You held all the way to the timer with no touch.	Your accumulated stake is forfeit. The keeper that closes the position receives a small bounty.
Aborted refund	The market is voided while your Ride is open.	A clean 1:1 refund of your escrow. No fees, no WICK mint, no penalty for being caught in a voided market.

The cashout valuation uses a continuous-time pricing factor (the same family of formulas that prices barrier options on professional desks). In plain terms: the closer you are to the barrier and the more time is left, the more your accumulated stake is worth on exit. That is the number you see ticking on the screen.

What can go wrong, and what the protocol does about it

Oracle jitter near the barrier

A single bad price tick could falsely register a barrier touch. Wick requires *multiple consecutive ticks past the barrier* before a touch is committed, and uses a small sub-spread buffer (a *deadband*) inside the barrier so that the oracle's natural noise floor cannot trip a settlement. A bad print no longer locks the outcome.

Stale oracle at expiry

If the oracle is silent long enough that the protocol cannot settle honestly, the market *aborts*. Aborted markets refund 1:1 to every depositor — never 2:1, never partial, never to the wrong side.

Settling a market twice

Settlement is *idempotent*. Repeating the call is a no-op or reverts. There is no way to re-mutate a settled market, and the same is true of redemptions — a winning position is consumed the moment it pays out.

Losing side claiming a win

The redemption check is explicit: only the side that matches the market's settled outcome can redeem. Aborted markets are a separate branch — both sides redeem at 1:1, no one can claim the winner's multiple.

Honest scope. Wick is currently demoed on Sui testnet. The protocol is not audited for mainnet. The oracle integrations for real underlyings are wired through swappable adapters; for the demo, the synthetic random-walk underlyings prove the full mechanism end to end without depending on any external feed. A mainnet deployment would require an external pricing audit, a multi-party upgrade key, and a redundant keeper fleet.

In one paragraph

Wick is short-dated touch options as a casual on-screen product. The trader picks a barrier, places a stake, and either watches the candle or — on a Ride market — holds the chart with their finger. The protocol settles against an oracle, not against a separate book. Loser stakes fund the vault that pays the winners; that same vault makes WICK available to losers as a fair-launch token; WICK stakers receive a share of every market's fees going forward. The whole system reconciles against a single accounting identity after every action, and an aborted market always refunds 1:1. There is no leverage, no liquidation, and the maximum loss is the stake.